

Sanity Testing

Focused validation to quickly confirm that a specific change works before broader testing.

What is Sanity Testing?

Sanity Testing is a focused verification of a specific change and its immediate dependencies to quickly decide whether the change makes sense and is stable enough for deeper testing. It is narrower than a general smoke test and usually starts from a known change.

Sanity vs Smoke

Smoke asks whether the build, in general, has minimum stability. Sanity asks whether a changed area looks coherent after a fix or small evolution. The terms vary between companies; what matters is aligning objective and scope.

When to use

After a fix, localized adjustment or small change when we need quick feedback before starting broader regression.

Practical example

Change: shipping calculation. **Sanity:** calculate shipping for a valid postal code, verify the main method, update quantity and confirm the effect on the total. If the basic calculation fails, it does not make sense to immediately move to dozens of combinations.

How to execute

Identify exactly what changed, select the main path and nearby dependencies, use representative data and look for obvious errors. If it passes, move to detailed tests; if it fails, investigate before expanding.

Appropriate depth

Sanity should not become full regression. It needs to be small enough to provide quick feedback, but deep enough to detect whether the central change is inconsistent.

Quick checklist

Change understood; main path; nearby dependencies; valid data; central rule; persisted result; obvious error; decision to proceed or block.

QA Mindset

Sanity is a focused question: “is this change healthy enough for me to invest in broader testing?”.